Christopher Vazquez

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EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology Cambridge, MA
Master of Science in Political Science *Sep 2026*

- Subfields: American politics and quantitative methods
- Relevant Coursework: Survey Research Design, Causal Inference, Generalized Linear Models, Topics in Machine Learning

Brigham Young University Provo, UT
Bachelor of Arts in Political Science *2022*

PROJECTS

Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Graduate Student, Race in Local Government Meetings (Master's Thesis) *Aug 2026*

- Built an LLM classification pipeline with the OpenAI API to segment and label roughly 8,000 city council meeting transcripts for racial language at scale to find mentions of race and examine the topics of discussions
- Tested the effect of city council racial composition on deliberation using a regression discontinuity design and two-way fixed effects, finding no detectable effect under either specification.
- Analyzed survey data showing that preferences for local government spending differ across racial groups.

EXPERIENCE

Massachusetts Institute of Technology Political Science Department Cambridge, MA
Research Assistant under Dr. Ariel White *Sep 2025 - Jul 2026*

- Built and maintained a full-stack R Shiny app that let undergraduate RAs review and classify TikTok videos on immigration enforcement, using the Google Sheets API as a live database to create a clean dataset.
- Developed a tool that transcribes TikTok audio and uses an LLM to extract dates and locations from the transcripts.
- Managed a team of 8 undergraduate RAs by training them, delegating work, and reporting their progress weekly.

Select Portfolio Servicing, Inc. Salt Lake City, UT
Investor Reporting Specialist *Oct 2022 - Jul 2023*

- Automated recurring Excel investor reports with a VBA and SQL tool, freeing colleagues to take on additional reports.
- Rotated through colleagues' report portfolios to automate reporting processes across the department.

Brigham Young University Political Science Department Provo, UT
Research Assistant under Dr. Adam Dynes *Jan 2020 - Oct 2022*

- Managed a team of ~6 research assistants building a database on municipal governments and elections, covering election timing, nonpartisan elections, council size, and city manager use.
- Analyzed American Municipal Officials Survey data using R to test whether framing effects shaped elected officials' spending decisions.
- Co-authored a working paper on framing effects and presented the findings in two poster conferences at BYU.

Brigham Young University Political Science Department Provo, UT
Teaching Assistant *Apr 2020 - Apr 2022*

- Graded assignments, essays, and exams for 30 to 40 students for American Government & Politics, State & Local Government & Politics, and Utah Legislative Politics.
- Held weekly office hours and review sessions, including classes of 30 to 200 students over Zoom.

Utah State Legislature Salt Lake City, UT
Legislative Intern, Utah State Senate *Jan 2021 - Mar 2021*

- Managed the schedule and inbox of a state senator as their sole staff during the 2021 session.
- Tracked and researched bills and prepared notes and talking points for the senator.
- Scheduled and prepared the senator for meetings with lobbyists, legislative leadership, and committees.

SKILLS

Programming: R, Excel/VBA, SQL, Python, Stata, HTML/CSS
Tools: OpenAI API, Google APIs, R Shiny, Git, Tableau
Methods: Causal inference, regression analysis, survey design, NLP & LLM text classification, data visualization